

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 6 3 2

♥ 8 4 2

♦ Q 2

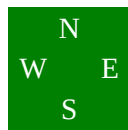
♣ 7 6 5 4

♠ K J 5

♥ K J 7

♦ A 9 6

♣ K Q 10 2



♠ A 10 9

♥ A 3

♦ K J 10 7 5 4

♣ J 9

♠ Q 7 4

♥ Q 10 9 6 5

♦ 8 3

♣ A 8 3

With 9 points you don't want to sign-off with 2♥.

But you aren't strong enough to force to game with a 3♥ bid either. So you start an invitational sequence by bidding 2NT.

Partner says 3♣.

Now you bid 3♥. Partner will realize you have better than a sign-off, but were not good enough to bid 3♥ immediately. He has a maximum, and he knows you have a 5-card suit, so he bids 4♥.

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

2♦

2NT

Pass

3♣

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

Lead: ♠3

**Board 2**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 4  
♥ A K Q 5 3 2  
♦ J 4 2  
♣ 9 6

♠ A J 6 3

♥ 9 4

♦ A 8 5

♣ K J 10 3



♠ 10 8 7 2

♥ J 7 6

♦ 10 9 6

♣ 8 5 2

♠ K Q 5

♥ 10 8

♦ K Q 7 3

♣ A Q 7 4

Partner's bid asks if you have 4 ♠s, and denies a ♥ stopper. (DIRECT DENIES)

You don't have 4 ♠s, nor can you stop ♥s. You have no choice but to bid one of the 4-card Minor suits, so you go up-the-line and bid 4♣. Partner bids 5♣.

*West**North**East**South*

2♥

3♥

Pass

4♣

Pass

5♣

All Pass

5♣ by South

Lead: ♥K

**Board 3**

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 8  
 ♥ 7 6 4  
 ♦ A J 9 7  
 ♣ 10 9 6 4

♠ Q 9 6 4 2

♥ Q 10 8

♦ 2

♣ 8 7 3 2



♠ K 7 3

♥ A 9 5 2

♦ Q 5

♣ A K J 5

♠ J 10 5

♥ K J 3

♦ K 10 8 6 4 3

♣ Q

It is possible your side can make 3NT on this deal.

You have 9 points, invitational strength, and your ♦ stopper is excellent.

However you should look for an even bigger reward by doubling. South is in serious trouble, and when the opponents make a mistake you should punish them.

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

2♦

Dbl

All Pass

2♦ by South

Lead: ♣10

**Board 4**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 5 2  
 ♥ 9 5 3 2  
 ♦ K Q J 6 3 2  
 ♣ —

♠ Q 10 8 4

♥ K 6

♦ A 10 7

♣ K 10 8 3



♠ 7 6

♥ J 10 4

♦ 8 4

♣ J 9 6 5 4 2

♠ K J 9 3

♥ A Q 8 7

♦ 9 5

♣ A Q 7

Partner's 2NT bid requests that you bid 3♣, so you do. He next says 3♦.

Partner's bid is game-forcing Stayman, but with a ♦ stopper (SLOW SHOWS). Holding 4 cards in each Major you bid up-the-line, 4♥. Partner now bids 3NT.

Partner would not have asked for a 4-card Major unless he held one himself. Since it wasn't ♥s it must be the other one. You bid 4♠.

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             |       |      | 1NT   |
| 2♦          | 2NT   | Pass | 3♣    |
| Pass        | 3♦    | Pass | 3♥    |
| Pass        | 3NT   | Pass | 4♠    |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 4♠ by South |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♦ K   |       |      |       |